

5 Different Route Development Alternatives, 1983

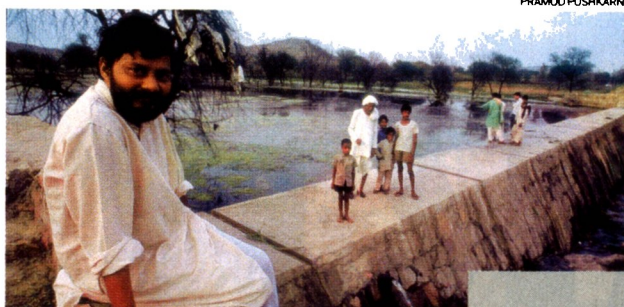
Labelled The Green Doer (INDIA TODAY, December 2002), Ashok Khosla empowered people by creating jobs. Through Development Alternatives, an NGO that he found in 1983, he began work towards financial, social and environmental sustainability at the grassroot level. Over the years, his 15 environmentally-sound and commercially-viable technologies have generated more than three lakh jobs across India.



ISHAN TANKHA

6 High Tide Narmada Bachao Andolan, 1985

It announced the arrival of the India Greens, protesting against destructive development. "One of the largest and most successful environmental campaigns, Narmada Bachao Andolan began with a wide developmental agenda, questioning the very rationale of large dam projects in India" (INDIA TODAY, December 2007).



PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

7 Sustaining Force Tarun Bharat Sangh, 1985

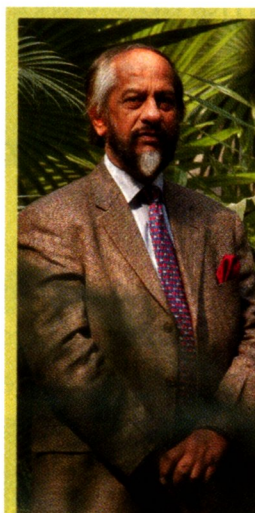
In Alwar's Hamirpur village, he is addressed as Ram. Rajinder Singh, founder of Tarun Bharat Sangh and winner of the 2001 Ramon Magsaysay Award acquiring the position wasn't a cakewalk. He brought water to about 850 parched villages in Rajasthan and motivated villagers to harvest rainwater. "He advocated small ponds and check dams but did not oppose big dams or canal networks blindly," said INDIA TODAY in December 2003.

8 Averting Disaster Saving the Western Ghats, 1988

Home to sanctuaries like Bandipur and Nagarhole, Western Ghats, a biological treasure trove, was struck by an epidemic—deforestation in the 1980s. "The Union Government's Forest Department estimates that within the last three decades, 4.5 million hectares of forests or an area the size of Tamil Nadu has vanished," said INDIA TODAY in March 1982. The Kailash Malhotra-led Save the Western Ghats march, a 100-day *padayatra* across the hills, succeeded in imparting the message of environmental degradation and human rights.



SAIBAL DAS



SUMET INDER SINGH

10 Climate Crusader The Research and Energy Institute

R.K. Pachauri became the watchdog of global warming. And so did The Research and Energy Institute. "Through his organisation, he stands at the forefront of international campaigns to reduce the debilitating climatic changes sweeping across the globe," said INDIA TODAY in February 2005.

9 Taste of War Target soft drinks, 2003

She earned the image of a fierce public warrior, when she took on powerful cola manufacturers. "Sunita Narain, director, Centre for Science and Environment (CSE), threw two cola giants, Coca Cola and Pepsico in the line of fire as 12 major brands of soft drinks in Delhi showed 15 to 87 times more levels of deadly pesticides known to cause cancer and other diseases." (INDIA TODAY, August 2003).

by Purvi Malhotra